

Choose the Best Network Monitoring Tool for Your Needs

Explore three network monitoring tools – Nagios, Zabbix and Zenoss - and evaluate their pros and cons in order to make an informed decision about which one to use.



A developer or a network manager needs to manage application servers and could get confused about which monitoring tool to use. In this article, let's look at the pros and cons of some of the most popular network monitoring tools.

One can't escape monitoring when it comes to managing servers. Something really reliable is needed; otherwise, things won't work the way they should. There are many monitoring tools out there, like some that use other administrators, and some that use text-based monitoring tools like Cricket; but these do not qualify as they are quite unreliable with respect to SNMP (Simple Network Management Protocol).

So, from experience, I've shortlisted the best monitoring tools to just three—Nagios, Zabbix and Zenoss. Let's explore their pros and cons, which could help you decide on which is the best one for you. Let's get started.

Nagios

This network monitoring tool was first released in March 1999, and is maintained by Ethan Galstad and other developers. Having proved its strength over so many years, it remains one of the best in the category. Originally designed to work on Linux, today it supports many UNIX variants.

The pros

- It is open source.
- Has a large community of developers to make it better, continuously.
- Adding new features is easy with plug-ins being available. If you don't find one you need, writing one for yourself with your own language tool is hardly a problem (shell scripts, PHP, Perl, Python, Ruby, C++ and more).
- It has a great optional Web interface for viewing current network status, notifications, log files, etc.